Salon Platform — Project Overview (Working name: SalonVue)

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The project in one minute

We are building a free online platform that helps small salons, barber shops and beauty parlours across India get more customers.

- **For salon owners:** a free web page, a Google Business Profile set up for them, and everything managed through WhatsApp in all major Indian languages.
- **For customers:** one place to find the right salon nearby, with real prices, real photos, today's deals and (later) live waiting time.
- **For the whole family:** men's barbers, women's parlours, kids' salons, bridal artists and home service in one place.

Our promise: the right salon near you, with today's deals and no waiting, for your whole family.

Salons join free. We earn from Google profile management, premium pages, a live queue subscription and brand advertising shared with salon owners.

The problem

Small salons are invisible online, customers can't see prices or waiting, and every earlier salon platform in India failed to fix this.

Problems of salon owners

- No website, and can't afford one.
- Google listing missing, wrong or never updated.
- No time to post photos or reply to reviews.
- Crowded on Sundays, empty on weekday afternoons.
- No proof whether any marketing brings customers.

Problems of customers

- Don't know prices before going.

- Don't know if the salon is crowded or even open (festival timings are often wrong).
- Fake or unclear reviews; can't see real work.
- Many customers are not comfortable with apps or long websites.

Why earlier businesses failed (Fabogo, Stylofie, Zoylee, Vyomo and others)

Reason	What happened
No real discovery need	People go to the same barber, so a plain directory wasn't used
Depended on discounts	Startups paid for discounts with investor money and lost money on every booking
Owners saw no proof	Owners never knew how many customers came from the platform
App dependence	Customers didn't download or keep using the apps
Grew too fast	Expanded to many cities before winning one
No revenue model	Free for everyone with no plan to earn

Our solution and how it works

We give every salon a free online presence that it manages from WhatsApp, and we give customers a reason to check our platform before every visit: deals and, later, no waiting.

How it works for a salon owner

1. We visit the salon and create its free page in about 5 minutes, with the owner's permission.
2. We set up or fix its Google Business Profile and link it to the page.
3. The owner manages everything on WhatsApp: send a photo, change a price, mark open or closed, or add an offer in any major Indian language. No voice notes.
4. Every week he gets a WhatsApp report: page views, calls, WhatsApp clicks, directions and customers sent.
5. A QR standee and mirror sticker in the shop bring his own customers to the platform.

How it works for a customer

1. Finds the salon page on Google, through a QR in the shop, or by searching our site. No login, no app.
2. Sees real photos, prices, timings, offers and verified reviews.
3. Taps Call, WhatsApp or Directions, or claims today's deal.
4. Gets a reminder on WhatsApp when it's time for the next visit.

Built for India

- All major Indian languages, big buttons; no owner voice-note management.
- Works on any phone browser; WhatsApp and missed-call options for people who don't use websites.
- The customer's phone number is the only ID, used only when needed.

Features by phase

We build in three phases: first the free directory and salon pages, then the live queue, then brand advertising.

Phase 1: Directory and salon pages (current focus)

- Free salon page: photos, price list, timings, map, Call / WhatsApp / Directions, reviews, open/closed.
- Categories for the whole family: men's barbers, women's parlours, kids-friendly, bridal and mehndi, home service.
- Family tags: kids-friendly, female staff, ladies section, home service, bridal packages.
- Area pages across India: "Best salons near you", "Salons open on Diwali".
- Google Business Profile set up and linked to the salon page.
- WhatsApp bot in all major Indian languages: "One photo, everywhere" updates the page, Google profile and Instagram.
- Weekly WhatsApp report to owners.
- Before/after gallery ("Looks of India").
- Deals and Happy Hours in empty hours, added by owners on WhatsApp.

- Optional custom domain for the salon; otherwise our domain is used.

Phase 2: Live queue and haircut recommendations

- Live waiting time on every salon page; search sorted by least waiting.
- Digital tokens with no app: from the web page, WhatsApp or a missed call.
- Voice alerts in all major Indian languages, 15 minutes before the turn; press 1.
- Barber presses one "Next" button; customers add themselves by QR.
- In-shop token board on a TV or old phone; alerts in all major Indian languages.
- Find Your Best Haircut: styles based on face shape, hair texture and length.
  Manual selection first; photo suggestions later. See the detailed feature below.

Phase 3: Brand advertising

- Ads on salon pages and in-shop token screens, chosen by brands using real data.
- Owner approves every ad and gets a share of the money.
- Start with local businesses (academies, gyms, clothing stores), then grooming brands.

What makes us different

Single features exist elsewhere; what nobody in India offers is the combination, free, built for small salons and run on WhatsApp.

Earlier mistake	How we avoid it
Directory only, no reason to return	Deals and (later) live waiting give a reason before every visit
Startup-funded discounts	Salons choose and fund their own offers, only in empty hours
No proof for owners	Weekly WhatsApp report: "We sent you 14 calls this week"
App download needed	Website, WhatsApp and missed call only
Owners had to learn dashboards	WhatsApp management in all major Indian languages
Fast, investor-funded growth	Bootstrapped, nationwide coverage, low running cost
No income for years	Google profile management earns from month 1

Not found in any Indian salon platform during our research:

- Free salon page plus Google profile; WhatsApp in all major Indian languages.
- "One photo, everywhere" to page, Google and Instagram.
- Weekly WhatsApp report of views and calls for small barbers.

Phase 2 (continued): Find Your Best Haircut

Purpose

Help customers explore suitable haircuts and hairstyles for men and women based on face shape, hair texture, hair length and personal preference.

Customer experience

1. Select a face shape manually; photo-based suggestions are added later.
2. Enter hair texture, current length and preferred style.
3. View hairstyle reference images and a short explanation for each suggestion.
4. Save a preferred style and find nearby salons offering it.

Rollout

Start with manual face-shape selection in Phase 2. Add optional photo upload and face-shape analysis in a later iteration of this feature.

Recommendation guidance

Present recommendations as style ideas. Face shape alone does not determine the best haircut; hair characteristics and personal preference also matter.

Photo privacy

Keep uploaded photos private. Delete them after analysis unless the customer explicitly chooses to save them.

- Directory, live queue and before/after gallery together across India.
- In-shop ad revenue shared with salon owners.
- Missed-call tokens with voice alerts in all major Indian languages.

How we make money

Salons join free; we earn from salons that want more and from brands, never from customer discounts. Prices below are suggestions to test with salon owners.

Revenue stream	Suggested price	When
Google Business Profile management	₹499–1,499 per month	Month 1 onward
Pro page (custom domain, more photos, offers, no other salons on page)	₹199–499 per month	Months 4–8
Domain sale with Pro page	About ₹799 per year	With Pro
Featured spot in an area (marked "Featured")	₹499–1,499 per month	Months 6–12
Live queue subscription	₹299–999 per month	Phase 2
Brand ads on pages and token screens	Revenue shared with owners, e.g. 40% owner / 60% us	Phase 3
Bridal and wedding enquiries	₹100–300 per lead	When parlours are listed

Free first: the basic page and WhatsApp bot stay free forever. Extra features are free during the launch period and become paid later; the first salons get lifetime discounted pricing as "Founding Salons".

Running cost estimate for about 500 salons: ₹2,500–6,500 per month (hosting, WhatsApp messages, image storage, OTP).

Competitors already in the market

Many companies do parts of this, but none combines a free salon directory, Google profile help, WhatsApp management and a live queue for small salons across India.

Company	What they do	Status / note
Google Maps / Business Profile	Free listings, reviews, calls	Main competitor for "salon near me"
Justdial	General directory with salon pages; paid packages	Active; only about 1 in 100 listings pays
SalonQ (Chennai)	Live queue, tokens, salon map with wait times	Active, closest to our full plan, Tamil Nadu only
QueueCut (Jamshedpur)	Booking + walk-in queue; free for salons, 12% customer fee	Pilot stage
Trymzo (Bihar)	Queue with WhatsApp tokens, no app	Early stage
SalonBoost	Barber software with queue, billing, WhatsApp; from ₹799/month	Active
Zylu, Dingg, Salonist	Salon management software, ₹600–3,000/month	Active, mostly bigger salons
Veloqit Bloom, AyeSalon, OwnChat	WhatsApp booking and reminders for salons	Active
Magicpin, Nearbuy	Deals and cashback, salons as one category	Magicpin shifted to food; Nearbuy unclear
Urban Company, YesMadam	At-home beauty services	Active
Fabogo, Stylofie, Zoylee	Salon directories	Failed, dormant or closed
Great Clips (USA)	Live wait time and online check-in since 2011	Successful; proves the queue idea

Competitor details come from their own websites and research done in October 2026; small apps may have been missed.